ADVENTURER GUIDE TO CAREERS

Make a living that allows you to express your creative freedom and imagination

16Personalities

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Introduction

Why Professional Development Matters to Adventurers

Adventurers, with a certain resistance to rules, hierarchies, and rigid processes, may struggle to find balance when it comes to academic and professional development. In traditional educational environments, they face unique challenges, and their innate talents and gifts are too often overlooked from an early age. As a result, some Adventurers may grow up with misgivings about their intelligence – or even their self-worth.

But an increasingly refined aesthetic sense, helping people with this personality type excel in endeavors related to art, design, and style, often helps balance this turmoil with a sense of individuality. In addition, their inherent spontaneity enables them to thrive in changeable, unpredictable circumstances, an ability that becomes more valuable once they progress beyond the structured world of early schooling.

Given the right environment, Adventurers' creativity and willingness to experiment can help them thrive in such fields as the visual arts, craftsmanship, music, film, and theater. Often highly independent, Adventurers aren't afraid to blaze unconventional or even risky paths in pursuit of their own version of success. This liberates them from social expectations and constraints, for better or for worse.

Adventurers can find balance by capitalizing on their spontaneity and subtle ambition in responsible ways, learning to weigh potential risks against potential benefits. Open-minded and considerate, they may question their own reasoning from time to time, and with the right mindset, they can assess feedback from others without becoming emotionally charged.

When possible, people with this personality type can also seek out academic and professional settings that take advantage of their natural strengths. If allowed sufficient freedom, flexibility, and novelty, Adventurers are capable of remarkable creativity and significant accomplishments.

In these pages, we'll discuss how Adventurers can bring the full force of their strengths to their academic and professional pursuits – and how they can stay motivated and make progress toward their longer-term

goals. Along the way, we'll cover how they can overcome challenges that people with their personality type often experience, including how to collaborate with people who don't see eye to eye with them and how to plan for the future without losing their spontaneous edge.

When they harness their talents and work through their weaknesses, Adventurers often find that their observational skills, creativity, and quick thinking are exactly what they need to achieve their version of success.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

Academic Path

Adventurers are naturally curious individuals who love learning new skills, especially those with practical benefits. True to their name, they see education as an opportunity to engage in experiences that result in gaining knowledge and skills applicable to their interests and preferred activities. Rock-climbing enthusiasts, for example, may pursue a degree in geology to learn more about the formations that they're in such close contact with.

Whatever path they take in their lives, Adventurers can benefit from embracing their education and looking for learning opportunities. Whether they're studying medieval history in the classroom or teaching themselves how to build websites in their own home, Adventurers profit from expanding their minds and increasing their expertise. The following paragraphs will discuss how Adventurers learn best throughout their educational career, the struggles they may face in the academic environment, and how they can improve their learning habits.

How Adventurers Learn

Hands-on mastery is the type of learning that appeals most to Adventurers. They learn best in loose and unstructured environments with loose and unstructured curricula that emphasize the experiential. Adventurers respond to a high level of personal involvement in their learning. They're usually restless in a lecture hall setting. However, if they discover their niche – acting, for example – Adventurers can express their love of performing on a stage in an auditorium or even in a classroom.

Balanced Learning Habits

Valuing Hands-On Experiences

Adventurers love to create. As long as they can make them themselves, it doesn't matter if it's artistic pieces, musical compositions, or beautiful graphic designs. People with this personality type don't respond well to just sitting still and absorbing information. Give them something to do, and they quickly become engaged. Allow them to express themselves in interesting and amusing fashions, and they'll shine, but ask them to recall a historical timeline, and they'll instantly lose interest.

Adventurers also enjoy coaching and feedback on their performance. Although nobody likes criticism, these types are serious about mastering what interests them and tend to appreciate any observations that can honestly help them accomplish this. The optimal learning style for Adventurers is to watch someone modeling a technique, immediately perform that same technique themselves, and then receive feedback on their performance. Once they mature and gain mastery, they're likely to then put their own spin on their work.

Unbalanced Learning Habits

Struggling with Traditional Structure

Even the most adaptable Adventurers can struggle in an overly-structured, traditional classroom setting – but this issue is much worse for those who have trouble operating outside of their trait preferences. Unfortunately, most academic environments focus on providing structure for students as if everyone learns in the same way. Because Sentinel personality types make up most of the population – and, consequently, educators – the idea that structured curricula work best is consistently reinforced in the academic world.

This system doesn't work well for many Adventurers, who are, ostensibly, the anti-Sentinels. This doesn't mean they don't like Sentinels or are against them; rather, they work in an almost opposite manner. Sentinels are rules-based, and they like to uphold tradition. They're orderly, think linearly, and favor the predictability of the traditional classroom model. Alternately, Adventurers tend to struggle in regimented environments.

Rebalancing Learning Habits

Finding a Niche

Parents and instructors who want to reach Adventurers and engage them in the learning process must help them find their niche and keep opportunities to be spontaneous open for them. They can give them something to work on independently, offering them some freedom to express themselves. Adventurers are always looking for something new and novel, and tend to respond to instruction that cultivates boldness and improvisation.

People with this personality type also like to reach decisions or conclusions in their own time based on what they discover. However, once they learn something, they may not wait around for others before they implement it. Instructors should have enough flexibility to accommodate this.

Still, it's important to remember that Adventurers are likely to only take so much spoon-feeding before they go off on their own. When teachers must give instructions, Adventurers usually respond best to multisensory learning using media and computers in novel ways. They need a wide range of activities rich in personal involvement. For these students, an effective activity is something physical, not an exercise on paper.

Adventurers in High School

If you've attended high school or ever watched one of the thousands of films about teenage angst, then you already know that there's more to high school than just academics. Most would agree there are as many lessons to be learned in school yards and hallways as there are in classrooms. So, let's take a moment to consider high school as a place where some important life lessons unfold.

Balanced Adventurers in High School

Independent and Innovative

Adventurers can be reclusive, especially if they feel out of place in the classroom. However, those who understand themselves and have found their niche can offset this tendency with their natural charm, boldness, and mastery of the right skills. Even if this occurs in areas outside of

the classroom, the effects can transfer; for instance, everybody gathers around the guy with a guitar at a party. Associating with Adventurers may even appeal to the rebellious streak in some of their otherwise conventional peers.

In terms of learning, Adventurers at their best understand the necessity of attending classes and getting passing grades. They may struggle with the structure but are likely to excel at anything that allows them to use their creativity to pursue a unique idea or to acquire new skills. Hands-on activities, such as building a bird house in shop class or participating in a model United Nations project for civics, can lead to greater interest and increased learning for these perceptive and practical students.

For many Adventurers, extracurricular activities and joining clubs or groups may represent more structure than they typically want. If they choose to participate, it most likely would be with groups that are more physical than cerebral and more skills-based than theoretical, such as art club or jazz band. Adventurers who find high school groups that interest them enough to join tend to be among the most passionate and committed participants.

People with this personality type rarely aspire to be in leadership positions. They dislike structure and are unlikely to impose it on others. Instead, they often serve throughout life in advisory capacities and can offer a lot to organizations by coming up with innovative ways of self-expression and problem-solving.

Unbalanced Adventurers in High School

Out of Sync with the System

Some Adventurers have a difficult time in high school. As discussed above, the typical classroom isn't a great fit for them. Their aversion to the structure of most classes might result in the impression that they're troublemakers or possibly even unintelligent. Within the traditional system, it's easy to miss the genius of another type lurking below the surface in such students. Unfortunately, too many teachers and parents lack this perspective, and they often view Adventurers as uncooperative or incapable.

Let the other students memorize cold, hard facts or play with ideas, but make sure Adventurers have something practical and tangible to do. In high school, point these students toward music, art, or other courses based on skill mastery. If left to struggle with traditional education, Adventurers are likely to earn poor grades and experience painful emotional and psychological distress. The constant message they receive from their school environment is that they're out of sync with everyone else. If it's clear to them they don't fit, this realization can cause a great deal of damage to their self-esteem.

Rebalancing Adventurers in High School

Relating Learning to Personal Interests

Many places are cutting or reducing their arts programs to tighten their budgets. These cuts can be disappointing for many reasons, but they're potentially devastating for students who perform creatively. If available or reasonable, transferring to a high school of the arts may be an appropriate option for Adventurer students. They may feel more at home in such an environment and receive a healthy dose of affirming feedback.

There are also many accredited alternative schools that cater to students who feel out of place in a traditional setting. These schools often allow students to create their own curricula and explore their talents in very active ways. These non-traditional schools could be great opportunities for Adventurers, but these students can also greatly benefit from counselors, teachers, or parents who understand this personality type.

Those Adventurers who form a connection with an activity or artistic expression won't only put in a great deal of effort to master it, but also may tolerate the passive lecture hall better. People with this personality type settle down and apply themselves more to school when they find their niche (or, in essence, themselves). When Adventurers can express themselves in ways that are true to their natures, they sometimes find more patience for subjects that wouldn't normally fit their interests. With a strong sense of fulfillment, they won't be as likely to feel as if they're denying themselves. Once Adventurers feel able to commit to something such as school, they're passionate and loyal people.

Work or College?

There are many factors to consider when deciding whether to go to college and understanding personality types can have a role in the equation. Most people previously considered college or university to be the quickest path to success and security. Now, some of these same people argue against higher education based on the amazing success stories of college dropouts, such as Bill Gates and Steve Jobs, during this current technological age. There's a niche for everyone, and college is just one possible path on the road to discovery. So, what might Adventurers consider when deciding between going to college or going to work?

It's easy to see action-conscious Adventurers wanting to get out into the world quickly to perform and produce, but their need to master their crafts can be just as insistent. These tend to be the two things that they must weigh and balance when thinking about higher education. College would be an unappealing choice for those Adventurers who look at it and see only lecture halls and books; but to those who see studios and practice rooms, higher education may be attractive.

Often, their perspective depends upon choosing the right major at the right college. Although Adventurer personalities could find an apprenticeship in the nonacademic world, college provides "ready-made" opportunities to learn from others. (Occasionally, Adventurers get into occupations requiring certification, in which case higher education is a necessity rather than a choice.)

When Adventurers Go to College

Adventurers who attend college or university are likely to feel as though they've been set free. Leaving home and high school for college offers many of them the independence and autonomy they crave. No longer bound by the rules of high school life, people with this personality type may finally find an educational model that fits their learning style.

Balanced Adventurers in College

Free to Find Their Own Way

Adventurers tend to choose college courses that share similarities with the subjects they connected with in high school. The artistic disciplines are a

primary interest for many Adventurer college students, along with various other active professions such as teaching, forestry, and psychology.

Adventurers are likely to avoid the pressure to choose majors and courses they struggled with in high school. Sometimes parents and guidance counselors, with all the best intentions, can send a high school graduate in the wrong direction in college. If Adventurer students didn't embrace more abstract, theoretical coursework in high school, the chances aren't any better for them doing so in college.

Unbalanced Adventurers in College

Too Focused on "Right Now"

Some think the purpose of college and university is to obtain the tools needed to make a good living. Most Adventurers, however, reject this as the primary reason to get a degree. Mastery and creativity tend to be the chief motivators for these students, and they're usually convinced that their passion can see them through. Some Adventurers may place their emphasis on picking up skills in the "here and now" with little regard for the future.

Do Adventurers look for "party schools" to strengthen their university experiences? Like most young people, they are likely to delight in the autonomy going away to college offers. For most students, this is their first significant taste of life without their families and their rules. Some even choose their universities based on the distance from the family home.

The same is true for Adventurers who are interested in coming into their own. They're Introverts, so a vivacious social life wouldn't necessarily be attractive to them. A few good friends tend to do nicely. However, nearly all students are susceptible to the temptations of college freedom, especially when they're under some emotional stress. Explorers all tend to seek a little adventure and novelty, which could, at least occasionally, draw Adventurers into the campus party world. They may want to exercise caution.

Rebalancing Adventurers in College

Learning to Deal with Difficulty

College is a time for Adventurers to consider and exploit their strengths and talents in real ways. This is their opportunity to customize their courses of study to a level that leaves them feeling fulfilled. One area of difficulty for collegiate Adventurers is the necessity of taking those unavoidable courses – the foundational prerequisites that many independent-minded students dread. Although some students "test out" of them, into every college career a little mundane classwork must fall.

Learning to cope with this can be good disciplinary practice for Adventurers. It won't be the last time they run into required tasks they find meaningless and boring. College can help self-aware Adventurers gain tolerance for such things and prepare them to approach the adult world in more realistic manners.

Conclusion

In aiming for the mastery that even the name "Adventurers" suggests, this personality type naturally embraces the role of lifelong learners in search of novelty and experiences. The initial trick in promoting learning for them doesn't involve directly motivating them or pushing them to improve skills, hoping their interest ignites after the fact. The trick is to help them find interactive disciplines that grab and inspire them up front.

On discovering such interests, Adventurers are likely to throw themselves into the academic process. Typically, when they find their niche, they look for ways to increase their expertise on their own. With this focus in place, they may even find education, in a broader sense, more appealing.

Adventurers can help themselves gain a foothold in academia by understanding how education and training work for them. Nurturing and indulging their tendency toward curiosity can be beneficial as they search for their passions. Exploring with a purposeful emphasis on discovery can help start them on their educational – and perhaps professional – paths.

Professional Development

Adventurers need more than a job. They need creative outlets and opportunities to put their imaginations to good use. In the right environments, Adventurers tend to find success and satisfaction by using their intrinsic qualities to their benefit – including their independence and their willingness to experiment.

Despite being bold and flexible, Adventurers face many unwanted challenges in their careers if they choose the wrong path. People with this personality type don't respond well when their skills and efforts aren't utilized or recognized. Ultimately, for them, it all boils down to picking careers that are good matches for their strengths and traits.

The Here and Now

Adventurers dislike speculating about the future or dwelling on the past; instead, they inhabit the here and now. This enables them to excel in fields that require sensory awareness and present-moment attention. When it comes to adapting to rapid changes, they're in their element. Given these strengths, many Adventurers shine as artists, musicians, photographers, designers, athletes, therapists, teachers, tour guides, and freelancers of all types.

This intense focus on the present comes with a cost: an aversion to long-term planning. This doesn't necessarily mean that Adventurers are reckless or shortsighted. Rather, they prefer to focus on managing

controllable factors and taking immediate action, not following multi-step procedures that might have some benefit in the future. Careers that require forecasting, theorizing, or performing routine or incremental tasks are typically poor fits for people with this personality type.

Live Free

Adventurers cherish their freedom and resist any attempts to force them into restrictive, predictable roles. Stable, unchanging positions and one-size-fits-all career ladders make them feel suffocated, not reassured. Even in otherwise pleasant environments, people with this personality type become restless if they can't follow their instincts and express themselves freely.

One reason Adventurers crave independence is so they can experiment and improvise without having to ask permission. They enjoy breaking molds and trying out new things – which is why they're often known as trendsetters. It's difficult to imagine Adventurers being happy in office cubicles, following top-down directives from nine to five. People with this personality type are free spirits, and they don't do well with strict structures, rigid expectations, or inflexible protocols.

Mastery and Freedom

Adventurers are often called artists for a reason – they have a keen eye for detail and excel in fields that reward creativity. People with this personality type leave building extensive systems or planning for contingency scenarios for more technical-oriented Analysts to conquer. When it comes to security and stability, favored qualities of Sentinels, Adventurers are uninterested. Finally, unlike Diplomats and despite their Feeling trait, Adventurers care little about diplomacy or idealism. Effectiveness often supersedes both.

People with the Adventurer personality type live and breathe creativity, seeking excitement and novelty at every possible moment with energy not always found in Introverts. They're passionate about developing mastery and pushing limits.

For exploring the unknown and reaching the heights of human ability, Adventurers can't be matched; it's their driving force and primary motivator. Their focus should be positioning themselves to master

specific techniques to benefit their employers, while also retaining enough freedom to choose their own methods. This may be a challenging task for many employers – however, smart managers won't take long to notice it's good to have Adventurers on board.

Practicality and Learning

Practical and down to earth, Adventurers typically remain levelheaded even when facing challenges. Where other types might focus on theories and methods, Adventurers concentrate on the reality of a situation when deciding how to proceed. They should steer their careers toward roles that reward practicality and efficiency. In addition, they should develop areas of expertise that allow them to focus on concrete details rather than abstract matters.

As they progress in their careers, Adventurers should indulge their interest in learning and work by seizing opportunities for education and experimentation. For instance, many organizations offer various training programs or subscriptions to professional magazines. Employers may even offer reimbursement for courses, conferences, or workshops. By taking advantage of such opportunities, Adventurers will not only stave off boredom in their career paths but also broaden their skill sets, potentially laying the groundwork for future advancement.

Tangentially, it's worth mentioning that this applies to educational qualifications as well. Regardless of whether Adventurers are employed or not, they might want to explore fields and subjects loosely connected to their main specialization. Plenty of areas reward Adventurers' tactical thinking and their skilled ability to see what needs to be done and do it. Keeping their eyes open can sometimes yield great results. Those not satisfied with their roles may want to try out new subjects as an easy way to open new horizons and boost self-confidence simultaneously. Another bonus is this doesn't necessarily require formal qualifications; nowadays, pursuing independent study is easier than ever.

They may also want to try finding hobbies with future income-generating potential. This approach is quite common among Adventurers, especially those who are in stable and well-paid positions that fail to excite them. The actual earnings don't matter that much in the beginning; what matters is the chance to do something that stimulates and inspires them, without the constraints of employer-employee relationships.

Career Options for Adventurers

Balanced Career Options

This section looks at some specific jobs that may fit Adventurers best, but it isn't an attempt to provide a full list of professions. As new and different career options are created almost daily, it would be impossible to comprehensively create a list of job choices. The sampling below is a list of occupations loosely compatible with Adventurer personality traits, along with some added explanation. This is a guide for Adventurers thinking about their own career goals.

For those who are already employed, this may serve as a confirmation or an explanation for why they might be happy or unhappy in their positions, but it's far from a firm prescription of what Adventurers must do to succeed or achieve fulfillment.

The Arts, Crafts, and Design

Adventurers love to be creative, particularly in tangible, concrete ways. Fine arts and crafts of all types appeal to their need for mastery and their drive to experiment. Music can appeal to these types, and Adventurers attracted to a career in music strive to become virtuosos.

The arts occasionally demand group participation – such as in an orchestra or on a film set – but artists and craftspeople do most of their work as individuals. For example, cellists can be members of orchestras or other ensembles, but, even as members of such groups, they still practice for hours on their own. These independent pursuits appeal to Adventurers, who generally thrive when they can avoid social pressures and "office politics."

Freelancing or working independently in creative careers allow Adventurers to set their own agendas, choose the problems they want to solve and chart their own timelines. These free spirits crave the opportunity to take risks without worrying about the reactions of others.

The following careers generally fit this description:

- Musician – instrumental, vocal, or composition
- Potter
- Painter
- Illustrator
- Sculptor
- Graphic artist
- Weaver
- Interior designer
- Fashion designer
- Jewelry designer
- Metal smith
- Photographer
- Woodworker (carpenter)

Mechanics and Engineering

Adventurers are attracted to the problem-solving nature of these types of positions, as they also typically appeal to their need for hands-on opportunities to create and innovate. These are also practical professions where real objects are modified in real ways. Engineers and mechanics often must collaborate with others and conform to rules, which can pose problems for Adventurers; however, they can also establish their own sphere of influence, within which they can explore and experiment freely.

Some specific occupations in this field include the following:

- Auto, boat, or airplane mechanic
- Small-engine mechanic
- Appliance repairer
- Heavy-equipment mechanic
- Engineer (mechanical, computer, structural, environmental, acoustic, robotic – any of the many branches of engineering)

Animal and Child Care

Many Adventurers do well in jobs that nurture others. Thanks to their sensory awareness and love of discovery, combined with their gentle and charming nature, they connect easily with children. Their patience and sensitivity also serve them well when working with animals. Some jobs that might use these special qualities are listed below:

- Veterinarian or veterinarian's assistant
- Animal trainer, groomer, or boarder
- Animal rescue worker
- Pet-adoption counselor
- Kennel manager or worker
- Preschool or early-education teacher
- Nanny
- Child psychologist or therapist
- Social worker
- Children's museum curator or docent (particularly if activity based)

Medicine

Medical careers can afford Adventurers the opportunity to master skills and use their problem-solving abilities in time-critical environments. As long as the work brings in new and interesting cases, these types do well in the medical professions. If mundane activities or restricted

protocols dominate the job, however, these positions can lose their appeal for Adventurers.

Overall, people with this personality type often do well in the healing professions. The following is a list of some possible roles:

- Nurse
- Doctor (general practice, specialist, or emergency medicine)
- Physician's assistant
- Midwife or doula
- Therapist or counselor
- Physical therapist
- Dentist or dental hygienist

Unbalanced Career Options

In modern society, we spend a great deal of time at work, but we also tend to find great meaning in our employment. It's important for Adventurers to avoid situations to which they're not well suited, as they may become stuck in a difficult position. Here are characteristics of jobs that may not be suitable for Adventurers.

Dependent on a Team

Adventurers like to operate independently. Although they may fare well enough as part of a loose team, they're more comfortable – and perhaps even more productive – when working on their own. Dealing with social and office politics or waiting on others can exhaust and frustrate Adventurers.

Mundane and Repetitive Work

People with this personality type crave novelty, spontaneity, and challenge. Repetitive work of any kind loses their interest, even if it's well compensated or otherwise advantageous. Unless they can use their improvisational skills, Adventurers become unfocused and bored.

Restrictive Environment

If the structure or the rules of a workplace are too rigid, Adventurers feel stifled and unfulfilled. When they can't act on their instincts, people with this personality type lose their edge on solving problems and facing challenges. Adventurers need the latitude to act swiftly and to take risks – two behaviors generally discouraged in hierarchical or rules-bound environments.

Alternative Options

Self-Employment

Many people find self-employment scary; however, gone are the days of spending decades working at the same company with ensured employment. Except for certain specialized fields, job security and guaranteed prospects are generally considered things of the past. Working for oneself can be a viable alternative to conventional employment.

This option also comes with a range of other benefits that appeal to Adventurers, such as planning their own time, seeing the tangible results of their work, and being their own boss. Adventurers value freedom and independence and being self-employed gives them an excellent opportunity to enjoy these things.

Self-employment essentially eliminates one of the major hurdles that Adventurers are likely to encounter in the corporate environment: forced compliance with numerous rules. As self-employed individuals, they may choose which tasks they want to perform and which they want to delegate or outsource. This self-determination can relieve them of any mundane administrative work or irrational orders they disagree with. Self-employment offers many major benefits to Adventurers, especially in today's global and always-connected environment. People with this personality are likely to succeed as their own bosses.

Entrepreneurship

Adventurers may feel comfortable with a business of their own making. Building an enterprise takes risk, which is a challenge they're ready and willing to take. Plenty of "entrepreneurs" have given up because

they were too afraid to jump into a pool full of what they perceived as sharks, but Adventurers are comfortable with risk and can deal with the consequences. People with this personality type know what it means to be entrepreneurs because they've been trying new and chancy things all their lives.

Without the right idea, though, a business will fail. Adventurers wishing to start their own business need to think of an interesting way to fulfill an existing need (or create one), then do it better than their competitors. As they tend to have an amazing ability to improvise, they typically are up to the task. If they have a strong idea from the start, they're likely to manage the rest with ease.

Getting on the Career Ladder

Adaptability is among Adventurers' greatest strengths. Even at school, which is a source of frustration for many with this personality type, they're likely to improvise, experiment, and cope with daily challenges. They love to make decisions on the spot, often refusing to plan for contingencies.

Like other Explorers, Adventurers are unstoppable when they find opportunities to master specific techniques or niches that give them the freedom to choose their preferred courses of action. Because finding such opportunities can be challenging, let's explore themes that can help Adventurers establish themselves on the right path.

Creativity and Experimentation

In both hobbies and aspirations, Adventurers excel when they embrace their creativity – whether this means photographing nature, designing homes, creating music, or even starting a business. Driven to become masters of technique, they love the practical challenges of getting just the right color, lighting, or sound. Adventurers who come up with a successful plan usually aren't content to stick to it, as other types might. Instead, they experiment and improvise, constantly pushing their limits.

Adventurers can embrace these strengths in the job-hunting stage. As Introverts, they may not especially enjoy networking or socializing, which is the primary means of getting a job for many other personality

types. By leveraging their creativity, however, many do just fine without an extensive social network. Thanks to the hours they've spent honing their expertise and trying new things, they can make resumes, CVs, and portfolios that stand out from the crowd.

To do so, Adventurers should highlight a range of past projects, list skill sets they've developed, and mention side gigs or hobbies where they've established mastery. Even if these details seem only tangentially related to the position, they emphasize their abilities in problem-solving and innovation and help distinguish them from the competition.

Finding the Right Job

With job interviews, Adventurers may not want to spend time preparing; instead, they trust their skills and enthusiasm can put them above everybody else. Many interviewers rely on template questions, though. Adventurers may lose out to other candidates who have prepared answers to common interview questions, such as "What's your greatest weakness?" or "Who are some people you admire?" By spending even a few minutes before an interview brainstorming likely questions and drafting answers, Adventurers can increase their chances of success.

On the flip side, Adventurers shouldn't hesitate to ask their interviewers questions, as it might be the only way they can determine whether a position is a good fit that allows for such things as room to experiment and freedom from micromanagement.

To do this effectively, people with this personality type should prepare relevant questions to ask their interviewers, like "What's the management structure like?" and "What types of decisions or actions would require approval from my manager or team?" Ultimately, unless they ask, Adventurers can't know whether a given professional environment can give them the breathing room they need in order to feel happy and motivated.

Workplace Cooperation Between Types

Adventurers may prioritize completing their projects and duties above making connections in a professional setting. To reach their full potential, most inevitably must collaborate and cooperate with other people. While their Feeling trait makes them likely to get along well enough with others, their independent streak pulls them their own way.

By thinking in terms of agreement and compromise rather than conflict, it's possible for Adventurers to enjoy constructive working relationships with any personality type. This section covers possible pairings of Adventurers with other Role groups, including brief overviews of potential synergies and obstacles, and some tips that may help Adventurers navigate these tricky waters.

Adventurer-Analyst Cooperation

Balanced Adventurer-Analyst Cooperation

One-Two Punch

Both Adventurers and Analysts enjoy the search for answers, although their style and scope of doing so are different. If they recognize that they're both looking for better ways to do things, their commonality can make discussions more productive. Early in their working relationships, they may come to appreciate each other's interest in efficiency and improvement.

As they become better acquainted, Adventurers and Analysts can learn to work together as a one-two punch. Adventurers function as implementers, using their present-moment awareness and adaptability to turn Analysts' often abstract ideas into reality. Consequently, Adventurers can sidestep theorizing and planning, neither of which is particularly appealing to them, in favor of quick action and improvisation.

For an illustration of this dynamic, consider Apollo 13, the space mission (and the eponymous movie) that brought us the iconic phrase, "Houston, we have a problem." After a mechanical mishap, three U.S. astronauts had to operate a crippled space capsule. Ground control – whom we might compare to Analysts – calculated all the numbers, ran analyses, and worked out a trajectory that could get the astronauts home. The astronauts – whom we might think of as Adventurers – then had to work as problem-solvers, implementing the plan and coping with mishaps along the way. In the end, the astronauts did indeed make it back to Earth safely, exemplifying how different functions and styles can work together to fulfill the same goal.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Analyst Cooperation

Ideas versus Action

When they first meet, Adventurers might feel as if Analysts ignore important details in favor of vague, impractical ideas and hypothesizing. As time goes on, it can be tempting for Adventurers to dismiss Analysts as having their heads in the clouds and not understanding the practical side of – well, anything. In return, Adventurers might be judged by Analysts as reckless or narrow-minded. In such situations, communication and collaboration can grind to a halt.

To make these situations worse, Analysts can be condescending, and Adventurers might feel as if their intelligence and worth are being called into question. This can open old wounds for Adventurers, whose strengths and intelligence may not have been recognized during their earlier years. As a result, Adventurers might stop listening to Analysts altogether, choosing to act as they see fit without input from their colleagues.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Analyst Cooperation

Connecting to the Big Picture

Although Adventurers enjoy details and implementation, they need to remember that Analysts don't share these preferences. Analysts are more likely to pay attention if Adventurers connect their words and

thoughts to the big picture, explaining how different courses of action affect the larger organization or system. For example, in a situation where Analysts are dragging their feet by weighing options instead of deciding, Adventurers might point out how missing their deadline may incur costs down the line.

Adventurers should also ask Analysts to give them feedback from a big-picture perspective. This can help Adventurers identify their blind spots, particularly any long-term considerations that they've been neglecting in favor of quick action and results. Such a vantage point can save Adventurers from going in a wrong direction or wasting their efforts.

R-E-S-P-E-C-T

Adventurers and Analysts, like all personality types, operate best in an environment of mutual respect. To cultivate this, Adventurers shouldn't rush to dismiss Analysts and their theories. After all, Analysts are seeking efficient outcomes, just like Adventurers. Instead, Adventurers can pose concrete, specific questions about their ideas, such as, "What type of budget would this entail?" and "What milestones would we want to set to stay on track?" These questions have a dual benefit: They remind Analysts of practical considerations, and they force Adventurers to acknowledge the merits of an analytical process.

Adventurer-Diplomat Cooperation

Balanced Adventurer-Diplomat Cooperation

Adventurers with their practical approach to life and problems and Diplomats with their more idealistic bent seem likely to conflict with one another. However, if, instead of thinking of these traits as opposite, these

types see them as complementary, there may be much potential for Adventurer-Diplomat cooperation. They find common ground when they tap into each other's passion and desire to bring about improvements.

The Pursuit of Something Better

Both Adventurers and Diplomats deploy their creativity in pursuit of something better. For Adventurers, this means finding novel and interesting solutions to practical and specific problems. They can look at a tangled mess of a program and figure out how to make it work – often in unique and interesting ways. Although Diplomats and Adventurers have a shared interest in improvement, Diplomats are more focused on personal growth, moral development, and well-being.

As their professional relationships together progress, Adventurers and Diplomats might discover additional common ground: Both types respect independence, and neither feels beholden to rules or convention. Together, these two types can enjoy productive and pleasant working relationships, particularly if their missions involve innovation and change.

Better Together

As with Analysts, Adventurers and Diplomats can function together as a one-two punch. Adventurers play to their strengths, focusing on acting and managing crises. Meanwhile, Diplomats use their Intuitive trait to generate and manipulate ideas, dealing with abstract concepts and planning for the long term – areas that don't interest Adventurers. Adventurers benefit from Diplomats' big-picture vision because they can stick to the hands-on work they prefer. Let someone else worry about all the broader "why" questions.

As an illustration, suppose that a Diplomat recognizes that an organization needs to create a greater sense of community and cohesion within its ranks. Communication around the office is poor, and the Diplomat senses a lack of connection among coworkers. An Adventurer might then step in to address the Diplomat's insight – for example, by creating an email newsletter, a phone chain, a podcast, or an agenda for lunchtime activities. In this relationship, the Diplomat can stick to generating ideas and insights, and the Adventurer can step in and act.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Diplomat Cooperation

Action versus Consideration

Adventurers may trust their instincts a little too much by putting their plans in motion without taking other people's opinions, views, or welfare into account. Such behavior can rile sensitive Diplomats, whose values include cooperation and harmony. By acting unilaterally, Adventurers may also ignore potential long-term consequences, upsetting Diplomats even further.

For example, Adventurers might want to publicize a new product as soon as possible, going so far as to alert the media and schedule a launch party before checking in with colleagues. This might cause Diplomats to lose their cool, pointing out potential issues that could delay production and arguing that key team members may be unable to attend the event. When communication breaks down in this way, Adventurers and Diplomats clash, losing sight of the benefits that can arise from their different approaches.

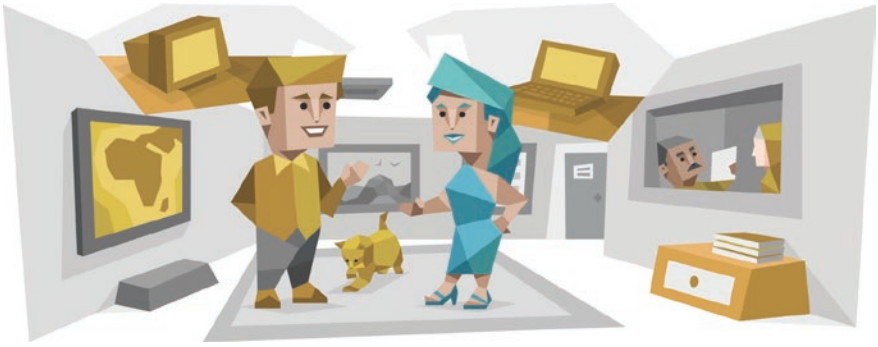
Rebalancing Adventurer-Diplomat Cooperation

Speaking Each Other's Language

Adventurers can teach Diplomats how to most effectively communicate with them. To do so, they can ask their Diplomat colleagues questions that bridge the gap between the here-and-now and future considerations – for example, "What benchmarks should we focus on hitting first?" or "How can we start working toward this goal today?"

In turn, Adventurers can communicate in ways that take advantage of the strengths Diplomats have to offer. This entails keeping them abreast of developments and action plans, allowing them to weigh in on potential conflicts or long-term consequences. When Adventurers sense that Diplomats are tuning them out, they can connect what they're saying to bigger-picture concerns or values – a surefire way to catch Diplomats' attention. For example, if an Adventurer says something along the lines of, "If we don't devote resources to fixing this problem now, then we risk losing our customers' trust," a Diplomat is likely to refocus and recognize the significance of a quality-control issue.

Adventurer-Sentinel Cooperation



It's easy to get the impression that Sentinels and Adventurers are opposites, as they often approach things differently. But they aren't without some commonalities. They both prefer to gather information directly from the world around them, instead of filtering it through internal mechanisms – neither type has much interest in theories.

While Adventurers are more in touch with things directly and immediately, Sentinels usually judge their experiences by remembering how things have always been. They're generally sticklers for rules and structures that support a traditional perspective. Adventurers relish the new and exciting, while Sentinels favor the stable.

Balanced Adventurer-Sentinel Cooperation

Troubleshooters

Adventurers and Sentinels can complement each other well when things go wrong. Sometimes even the tried-and-true ways of doing things fail us. This can be disconcerting for Sentinels – but a compelling problem to solve for Adventurers. When it's time to experiment, there are few people better to step in and help Sentinels than Adventurers.

However, Adventurers in such situations can benefit from Sentinels, too. Adventurers might feel tempted to act impulsively. When this happens, Sentinels can ground them and help them retrace their steps as necessary. Sometimes, boldly "winging it" can lead to effective solutions, and sometimes, this approach can create more problems than it solves. If willing, Adventurers and Sentinels can negotiate a balanced approach to tackling challenges together.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Sentinel Cooperation

Order versus Flow

Adventurers may also feel as if Sentinels are continually blocking their efforts to try new things – whether this means hiring a new vendor or even buying a different type of printer paper. Adventurers don't mind cutting corners when necessary, but Sentinels want those corners to remain intact – just the way they've always been. This can trigger tension and disagreement.

In unbalanced working relationships, Adventurers can come across as reckless and undisciplined to Sentinels. Meanwhile, Adventurers might perceive their Sentinel colleagues as boring or uninspired. Such misperceptions can hinder trust and open communication.

For example, an Adventurer might want to hire a different graphic designer to create a company's annual brochure. A Sentinel might very well object, insisting that the designer who's always done the brochure would be the best choice. The Adventurer might roll their eyes at the Sentinel's stodginess and hire the new designer anyhow, reasoning that a better product is worth leaving their colleague in the dark.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Sentinel Cooperation

The Value of Protocols

As philosopher George Santayana wrote: "Those who cannot remember the past are condemned to repeat it." Adventurers can be too quick to dismiss Sentinels' attachments to the past and its settled protocols. To satisfy their own curiosity and make Sentinels feel heard, Adventurers can ask specific questions about their views, such as, "What do you see as the risks of veering from the status quo?" and "What would help you feel reassured about trying a new course of action?"

Mutual Learning

For Adventurers, accepting Sentinels' counsel may help them avoid problems. They might benefit from experimenting with Sentinels' suggestions, even if they seem too rooted in tradition. Adventurers are

at low risk of permanently losing their spontaneity and edgy creativity by occasionally playing by the rules.

When Sentinels offer counsel that proves to be sound, Adventurers should take a moment to acknowledge them. Sentinels may never ask for it, but they're always happy when someone shows appreciation. By offering credit when it's due, Adventurers can build stronger working relationships with them.

Adventurer-Explorer Cooperation

Adventurers and their fellow Explorers typically find themselves "speaking the same language." Theoretical and conceptual problems, which thrill Analysts, seem superfluous or annoying to both. Conversations about solving problems or mastering skills or situations are of greater interest. People with these personality types gain energy and motivation from acting, not from pausing to consider the meaning of life.

Balanced Adventurer-Explorer Cooperation

Getting the Job Done

When working together, Adventurers and other Explorers want to figure out the best way to do the job. They may bypass rules, standards, or traditions that hinder their strategies. Because of this pronounced spontaneity and independence, other types often see them as risk-takers. In the workplace, Adventurers may bond with other Explorers who share this willingness to experiment and break from protocol.

Practical Innovation

Working together, Adventurers and Explorers can free an organization from being stuck in a rut and following old, ineffective patterns. They may not spend their days making diagrams on whiteboards, but by jumping in and solving problems on the fly, together they often innovate in ways that create new best practices. The harnessed energy of Adventurers and other Explorers can be a formidable asset to any organization.

Unbalanced Adventurer-Explorer Cooperation

But at What Cost?

Adventurers and Explorers might feel so in tune with one another that they stop soliciting – or listening to – feedback from other colleagues. These two types can become trapped in their thinking style and lose the benefit of insight and perspective from those with different thought processes. If not balanced by the ideas and advice of other personality types, Adventurers and Explorers may act impulsively or take needless risks in their drive to get things done.

This drive to act and accomplish can also motivate Adventurers and Explorers to put practical solutions ahead of the feelings and concerns of others. It's not that they don't like their colleagues, especially those with the Feeling trait, but people tend to fall below solutions on their priority lists. The result can be a gulf between them and other coworkers.

Solutions with a Small Perspective

Adventurers and other Explorers might also find that their actions, although efficient in the short term, don't align with their organization's larger vision. Because both types are detail oriented and think in the present, they may disregard their company's overall concept of objectives and focus. Just as it takes only one degree of a compass to send a ship hundreds of miles off course, a small, misguided solution can disrupt an organization's larger goals.

The immediacy of the shared mindset of Adventurers and Explorers can create a type of tunnel vision if not adjusted and kept in check. Even when both types don't recognize the problem, their supervisors might accuse them of thumbing their noses at the vision and values of the company.

Rebalancing Adventurer-Explorer Cooperation

Appreciating Commonalities

When Adventurers and Explorers work together, they can take advantage of their easy camaraderie by brainstorming new and better ways of doing things. The two types are likely to come up with fresh approaches and promising experiments. They can make the work experience even more productive and rewarding if they find something to tinker with while they're chatting.

Getting a Second Opinion

When two types are so similar, a second opinion from someone with a different perspective is often essential. To identify their blind spots, Adventurers and Explorers can ask colleagues with other personality types for feedback. By doing so, they can push beyond their comfort zones – something both Adventurers and Explorers often enjoy.

Asking "Why?"

Adventurers and Explorers who work together may find they're comfortable exploring the "how" questions involved in finding a solution. Learning to ask "why" may be just as essential. This, again, may require a second opinion from someone who's more in touch with the overall concept. By pausing to contemplate the "why" of their actions, Adventurers and Explorers can increase their efficiency and direct their energy in ways that align with the big picture.

Conclusion

Adventurers need to exercise independence – their autonomy is essential to their happiness, and it motivates them to produce and succeed. If a job feels like overstructured conformity based on unskilled actions, Adventurers won't be able to access that part of themselves that responds in healthy ways to challenges.

To thrive in their work, Adventurers must find a niche that's their own. Most are good at this, having practiced it while dealing with school systems focused on more conventional things than they, as young people, could relate to. While not always good at commitment in any traditional sense, once they find their niche, they're usually all in for the duration. This allows them to become highly skilled and often specialized – making them valued workers and professionals in many fields.

Final Words

Independently Passionate

Creative and often artistic, Adventurers seek to apply a fresh spin to ideas that they're passionate about. When it comes to academics and the professional realm, this can sometimes create challenges if they come up against highly structured environments and processes. Naturally resistant to rules and hierarchies, and with a strong need for independence, people with this personality type will want to carefully consider academic and career options that offer them rich experiences and plenty of opportunities to let their ingenuity shine.

Often, Adventurers dabble in what they find aesthetically pleasing, but they thrive in any situation where they are allowed freedom of expression and opportunities for experiential work and learning. They are "doers," and their professional trajectory often reflects this fundamental aspect of their personality.

When it comes to working with others, Adventurers' impulsiveness and unique perspectives can come across as unpredictable and unconventional. These tendencies need not debilitate Adventurers, however. Their perceptive sensitivity combined with their imagination and willingness to act often results in finding solutions and moving projects forward.

In these pages, we've discussed how Adventurers can draw on their gifts and overcome common obstacles as they go after their academic and professional goals. Our hope is that these insights will help Adventurers make progress toward their version of success without sacrificing the independence and expression that they crave in their lives. With their bold creativity and ability to adapt to whatever the present moment calls for, Adventurers who lean into their strengths and work through their challenges can grow into exactly the movers and shakers that this world so desperately needs.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you better understand and strengthen your academic and career paths? Explore our Career Specialized Tests.
- Looking to enhance your relationships with your partner, your friends, or your children? Check out the *Adventurer Guide to Relationships*.
- Ready to build a strong foundation for your self-development? Our *Adventurer Guide to Personal Growth* may be just what you need.

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